Class 8 Social Science – Chapter 3: The Rise of the Marathas

इस अध्याय की PDF के आधार पर सभी पाठ्यपुस्तक प्रश्नों के उत्तर सरल अंग्रेजी में दिए गए हैं। साथ ही, प्रत्येक प्रमुख टॉपिक से महत्वपूर्ण, संभावित परीक्षा प्रश्न और उनके उत्तर भी शामिल हैं। उत्तर कक्षा 8 के विद्यार्थियों के स्तर के अनुसार रखे गए हैं।

Source: NCERT, Exploring Society: India and Beyond, Grade 8, Part 1, Chapter 3, pages 61–81.

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Part A: Answers to all textbook questions

1. Analyse how geography, particularly mountains and coastlines, guided Maratha military strategy and state formation.

Answer: The mountains provided natural protection to the Marathas. They built and controlled many forts on hills to protect their kingdom and important routes. They used guerrilla warfare, which involved speed, surprise and knowledge of the land. The long coastline encouraged Shivaji to build a strong navy. The navy protected coastal areas and trade routes. These geographical advantages helped the Marathas build and defend their kingdom.

2. Write a short biography of a Maratha leader.

Answer: Ahilyabai Holkar

Ahilyabai Holkar was a great Maratha ruler of the Holkar dynasty. She ruled for about thirty years and cared for the common people.

She faced the difficult loss of her husband and son but continued to govern wisely. She built and restored temples, ghats, wells and roads in many parts of India.

She rebuilt the Kashi Vishwanath Temple in Varanasi and supported the Maheshwar weaving industry. Her life teaches us courage, kindness and public service.

3. Which Maratha fort would you like to visit and why?

Answer: I would like to visit Raigad Fort in Maharashtra. Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj was crowned here in 1674. The fort was an important centre of Maratha power. I would like to learn about its architecture, history and role in protecting the Maratha kingdom.

4. What does the statement “The British took India from the Marathas more than from the Mughals or any other power” mean?

Answer: The statement means that the Marathas controlled large parts of India before British power became dominant. They were among the strongest rivals of the British in the eighteenth century. Three Anglo-Maratha Wars were fought between 1775 and 1818. Internal disunity and the superior organisation and technology of the British led to the end of Maratha power in 1818.

5. Compare how Chhatrapati Shivaji and later Marathas treated religious places and people of different faiths.

Answer: Chhatrapati Shivaji respected other religions while following his own faith. He avoided attacking religious places during the sack of Surat and showed concern for his subjects. He also forbade the Dutch from trading slaves. The chapter describes the Marathas as reviving local Hindu traditions without religious discrimination. Their approach combined cultural pride with respect for different faiths.

6. Why were forts the core of the Maratha state?

Answer: Forts protected the kingdom from enemy attacks. They controlled important routes and provided shelter to soldiers. They also helped the Marathas use guerrilla warfare effectively. Even during long wars against the Mughals, their forts helped them survive and defend their independence.

7. Design a coin that represents Maratha achievements and values. Explain its symbols.

Answer: I would design a gold-coloured coin with the following symbols:

- A fort: It would represent strength and protection.
- A sailing ship: It would represent the Maratha navy and maritime power.
- A rising moon: It would represent progress and prosperity.
- A Sanskrit or Devanagari inscription: It would represent cultural identity.
- The words “Swarajya and Welfare of the People”: They would represent self-rule and good governance.

8. What was the most important contribution of the Marathas to Indian history?

Answer: In my opinion, the most important contribution of the Marathas was their promotion of Swarajya, or self-rule. Under Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj, they challenged powerful empires and established an independent kingdom. They developed effective administration, built forts and maintained a strong navy. Their achievements inspired confidence among Indians and contributed to cultural revival.

Textbook questions and answers are based on the exercise on page 81 of the uploaded chapter.

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Part B: Important and probable questions from every topic

Topic 1: Who are the Marathas?

Q1. Who were the Marathas?

Answer: The Marathas were a group of people native to the Deccan Plateau, especially present-day Maharashtra. They spoke the Marathi language.

Q2. Which language did the Marathas speak?

Answer: They spoke Marathi, a language with a rich literary history dating back to the twelfth century.

Q3. Who ruled most of Maharashtra during the thirteenth century?

Answer: The Yadava dynasty ruled most of Maharashtra. Its capital was Devagiri, now called Daulatabad.

Q4. Which dynasty overcame the Yadavas in the fourteenth century?

Answer: The Khilji Sultanate from Delhi overcame the Yadava dynasty.

Q5. What was the Bhakti movement?

Answer: The Bhakti movement was a religious movement based on devotion to God. Saints composed devotional songs and poems in local languages so that ordinary people could understand their teachings.

Q6. Name some important Bhakti saints of Maharashtra.

Answer: Dnyaneshwar, Namdev, Tukaram and Ramdas were important Bhakti saints of Maharashtra.

Q7. How did Bhakti saints help Maratha society?

Answer: They spread religious and philosophical ideas in Marathi. Their teachings helped create cultural unity and social awareness, which later supported the rise of the Marathas as a political power.

Topic 2: Foundation of Maratha Power and Shivaji Maharaj

Q8. When and where was Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj born?

Answer: Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj was born in 1630 in the Bhonsle clan to Shahji and Jijabai.

Q9. Who were Shahji and Jijabai?

Answer: Shahji was Shivaji's father and served the Deccan Sultanates. Jijabai was his mother and played an important role in his upbringing.

Q10. What is a jagir?

Answer: A jagir was a piece of land given by a king or ruler to a person, usually a noble or soldier, as a reward for service. The holder could collect taxes from the land.

Q11. When did Shivaji begin his rule?

Answer: Shivaji began his rule in 1646, according to the timeline in the textbook.

Q12. What was Swarajya?

Answer: Swarajya means self-rule. Shivaji wanted to establish an independent kingdom governed according to his political, economic and cultural vision.

Q13. How did Shivaji begin expanding his kingdom?

Answer: At the age of sixteen, Shivaji began military campaigns. He captured neglected and unoccupied forts in the Pune region and strengthened their defences.

Q14. Why was Shivaji's navy important?

Answer: Shivaji built a navy to protect the western coastline, secure coastal resources and defend maritime trade. It was an important step because major powers such as the Mughals had only limited naval forces.

Q15. What is guerrilla warfare?

Answer: Guerrilla warfare is a method of fighting in which small groups use speed, surprise and knowledge of the land to defeat larger armies.

Q16. How did Shivaji defeat Afzal Khan?

Answer: Shivaji arranged a meeting with Afzal Khan near Pratapgad Fort, in a forested area. Shivaji killed Afzal Khan, and the Marathas used surprise attacks from the surrounding mountains to defeat his army.

Q17. What was the wagh nakh?

Answer: The wagh nakh was a small weapon shaped like a tiger's claw. Shivaji used it in close combat against Afzal Khan.

Q18. What happened during Shivaji's raid on Shaista Khan's camp?

Answer: Shivaji attacked Shaista Khan's camp at night with a small group of soldiers. Shaista Khan narrowly escaped, losing some fingers, and left Maharashtra. The textbook compares this daring raid to a modern surgical strike.

Q19. Why did Shivaji sack Surat?

Answer: Shivaji sacked Surat, a wealthy Mughal port city, in retaliation for repeated Mughal attacks on his territories. He obtained a large amount of treasure but avoided attacking religious places and spared the house of Mohandas Parekh, a charitable man.

Q20. What was the Treaty of Purandar?

Answer: After facing the Mughal general Jai Singh, Shivaji had to accept defeat at Purandar Fort and enter into a treaty. He surrendered a considerable part of his kingdom, and his son Sambhaji entered Mughal service.

Q21. How did Shivaji escape from Agra?

Answer: Aurangzeb placed Shivaji under house arrest at Agra. Shivaji arranged for gifts of fruits and sweets to be sent out in large baskets. He and his son Sambhaji hid in the baskets and escaped.

Q22. When and where was Shivaji crowned?

Answer: Shivaji was crowned in 1674 at Raigad Fort. His formal title was Shri Raja Shiva Chhatrapati, and he began a new era called the Rajyabhisheka Shaka.

Q23. What was Dakshina Digvijaya?

Answer: Dakshina Digvijaya was Shivaji's conquest of the South in 1677. It included parts of present-day northern Tamil Nadu and Karnataka. It gave the Marathas greater strategic depth against Mughal invasions.

Q24. How did Shivaji show concern for his subjects?

Answer: Shivaji instructed his officials not to mistreat people or seize their property by force. He protected religious places, supported soldiers' families and forbade the Dutch from trading slaves.

Topic 3: The Marathas after Shivaji

Q25. Who succeeded Shivaji as Chhatrapati?

Answer: Shivaji's son Sambhaji succeeded him as Chhatrapati.

Q26. What happened to Sambhaji?

Answer: Aurangzeb captured Sambhaji and executed him after severe torture. The Mughals also captured Raigad, the Maratha capital.

Q27. Who was Rajaram?

Answer: Rajaram was Shivaji's younger son. After Sambhaji's death, he became Chhatrapati and fled to Gingee in present-day Tamil Nadu.

Q28. Who was Tarabai?

Answer: Tarabai was Rajaram's queen and a brave Maratha warrior queen. She organised large Maratha armies and led attacks on Mughal territories. She played a major role in the northward expansion of Maratha power.

Q29. Why could Aurangzeb not subdue the Marathas?

Answer: The Marathas strongly defended their forts and often gained the upper hand in battles and smaller clashes. Their resistance prevented Aurangzeb from fully conquering the Deccan.

Q30. Who was a Peshwa?

Answer: A Peshwa was the prime minister of the Maratha state. Over time, Peshwas gained great political and military influence.

Q31. Name two Peshwas who helped expand Maratha power.

Answer: Peshwa Bajirao I and his son Nanasaheb Peshwa helped expand Maratha power across India.

Q32. What was the importance of the Battle of Panipat in 1761?

Answer: The Marathas suffered a major defeat at Panipat in 1761 while fighting the Afghans. However, they recovered under Peshwa Madhavrao I.

Q33. Who was Mahadji Shinde?

Answer: Mahadji Shinde, also known as Mahadji Scindia, was a powerful Maratha leader. Under his leadership, the Marathas recaptured Delhi in 1771.

Q34. When did Maratha power end?

Answer: Maratha power ended in 1818 after the Third Anglo-Maratha War.

Q35. Why did the British defeat the Marathas?

Answer: Internal disunity among the Maratha chiefs and the superior organisation and technology of the British helped the British defeat the Marathas.

Topic 4: Maratha Administration

Q36. What kind of administration did Shivaji establish?

Answer: Shivaji established a relatively centralised administration. He abolished hereditary government posts, paid officials from the state treasury and transferred many officials periodically.

Q37. How did Shivaji care for soldiers' families?

Answer: He gave pensions to the widows of soldiers who died in battle. He also offered military posts to their sons.

Q38. What was the Ashta Pradhan Mandal?

Answer: The Ashta Pradhan Mandal was a council of eight ministers who helped Shivaji administer his kingdom.

Q39. Name the eight ministers and their main duties.

Minister	Main duty
Pradhan	Prime Minister
Amatya	Finance
Sachiv	Land revenue
Mantri	Intelligence
Nyayadhish	Chief Justice
Sumant	Foreign affairs
Senapati	Commander-in-chief
Panditrao	Religious affairs

Q40. What were chauth and sardeshmukhi?

Answer: Chauth was a tax equal to 25 per cent, and sardeshmukhi was an additional 10 per cent. The Marathas collected these taxes from some provinces outside their direct control in return for protection and non-interference in internal administration.

Q41. How did Shivaji show his sovereignty through coins?

Answer: Shivaji minted gold and copper coins in his own name. The use of Devanagari script on his coins expressed his cultural identity and sovereignty.

Topic 5: Military Administration, Forts and Navy

Q42. What were the three main parts of the Maratha armed forces?

Answer: The three parts were infantry, cavalry and navy.

Q43. Who were the bargirs and shiledars?

Answer: Bargirs were cavalry soldiers whose horses and equipment were paid for by the state. Shiledars paid for their own horses and equipment.

Q44. Which weapons did the Marathas use?

Answer: The Marathas commonly used swords and lances. They also used guns and rockets. Metal-tube rockets were being used by 1770.

Q45. Why were forts important to the Marathas?

Answer: Forts controlled important routes, protected soldiers and helped the Marathas defend their territory. They were essential to guerrilla warfare and helped the Maratha state survive long Mughal attacks.

Q46. Who was Kanhoji Angre?

Answer: Kanhoji Angre was an important Maratha naval leader of the eighteenth century. He won many naval battles by using geographical advantages and clever tactics.

Q47. What was a cartaz?

Answer: A cartaz was a Portuguese naval trade pass. European powers demanded that Indian ships carry such passes. The Marathas challenged this practice and demanded passes from Europeans as well.

Q48. Why did Europeans call Kanhoji Angre a pirate?

Answer: Kanhoji Angre challenged European naval control and demanded passes from European ships. The Europeans called him a pirate because he opposed their control over maritime trade.

Topic 6: Judicial System and Trade Networks

Q49. How was justice delivered under the Marathas?

Answer: Local panchayats, made up of officials and prominent men, were the main bodies that delivered justice. People could appeal to a Maratha chief if they were unhappy with a decision. The system was moderate in its use of the death penalty.

Q50. What was the role of the kotwal?

Answer: The kotwal was a police official responsible for maintaining law and order in towns such as Pune and Indore.

Q51. How did Shivaji promote trade?

Answer: Shivaji encouraged trade and took part in maritime foreign trade. Maratha ships carried goods such as gold and textiles to distant ports.

Q52. Name some foreign ports connected with Maratha trade.

Answer: The Marathas traded with Mocha in Yemen, Muscat in Oman and Malacca in Malaysia.

Q53. How did the Marathas improve transport?

Answer: They constructed and maintained roads, built bridges over rivers and small streams, and maintained ferry networks for river transport in some regions.

Topic 7: Cultural Revival

Q54. How did Shivaji promote Marathi and Sanskrit?

Answer: Shivaji commissioned a work called Rajya-Vyavahara-Kosha. It provided Sanskrit equivalents for Persian words used in official communication and helped promote Marathi.

Q55. What was special about Shivaji's royal seal?

Answer: Shivaji's seal carried a Sanskrit inscription. It expressed the idea that his authority would grow and work for the welfare of the people.

Q56. How did the Marathas contribute to cultural revival?

Answer: They promoted Marathi and Sanskrit literature, supported religious institutions and traditional arts, restored temples and encouraged confidence in Indian cultural traditions.

Q57. What was the Modi script?

Answer: Modi was a cursive form of Devanagari. It was the main script used by the Marathas for correspondence.

Q58. How did the Marathas contribute to the culture of Odisha?

Answer: The Bhonsles of Nagpur supported local culture and traditions. They helped revive the worship of Lord Jagannath at Puri, which had often been interrupted during Mughal rule.

Topic 8: The Mighty Maratha Women

Q59. What were Tarabai's major achievements?

Answer: Tarabai organised Maratha armies and led attacks on Mughal territories when Aurangzeb was in the Deccan. Her military strategy helped preserve Maratha independence and encouraged expansion towards northern India.

Q60. Who was Ahilyabai Holkar?

Answer: Ahilyabai Holkar was a ruler of the Holkar dynasty who governed for about thirty years. She was known for wise administration and care for ordinary people.

Q61. What were Ahilyabai Holkar's contributions?

Answer: She built and restored temples, ghats, wells and roads across India. She rebuilt the Kashi Vishwanath Temple and the Somnath Temple and supported the Maheshwar weaving industry.

Topic 9: The Marathas of Thanjavur

Q62. Who was Ekoji?

Answer: Ekoji was Shivaji's half-brother. He conquered the Thanjavur region in present-day Tamil Nadu in the late seventeenth century, beginning Maratha rule there.

Q63. What was special about Thanjavur's cultural environment?

Answer: Tamil, Telugu and Marathi cultures interacted freely in Thanjavur. This created a multilingual and mixed cultural environment.

Q64. Who was Serfoji II?

Answer: Serfoji II was a notable ruler of the Thanjavur Marathas. He supported literature, music, medicine, printing and education.

Q65. What were Serfoji II's contributions to culture and science?

Answer: He wrote a Marathi play called Devendra Kuravanji, supported musicians and helped develop Carnatic music and Bharatanatyam. He established Dhanwantari Mahal, which offered free treatment using Indian and Western medicine, and started a printing press.

Topic 10: The Maratha Legacy

Q66. What was the greatest legacy of the Marathas?

Answer: Their greatest legacy was the idea of Swarajya, or self-rule. They challenged Mughal dominance, built an extensive empire, developed effective administration and inspired cultural confidence among Indians.

Q67. How did the Marathas influence India's freedom movement?

Answer: Their struggle against powerful empires showed that Indians could govern themselves. Their ideal of Swarajya helped inspire later ideas of self-rule and contributed to the early roots of India's freedom movement.

Q68. What are the main points to remember about the Maratha Empire?

Answer:

- Shivaji founded the Maratha kingdom in the seventeenth century.
- The Marathas resisted Mughal power for decades.
- They expanded across large parts of India in the eighteenth century.
- Forts and the navy were important to their military strength.
- Their administration, trade and cultural activities left a lasting legacy.
- British power ended Maratha dominance in 1818.

These topic-wise questions are study questions prepared from the chapter's text, diagrams and summary. They are not an official list of predicted examination questions.

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Part C: Very short-answer questions for quick revision

Question	Answer
1. In which year was Shivaji born?	1630
2. Where was Shivaji crowned?	Raigad Fort
3. In which year was Shivaji crowned?	1674
4. What does Swarajya mean?	Self-rule
5. What was the capital of the Yadavas?	Devagiri
6. What was the wagh nakh?	A tiger-claw-shaped weapon
7. What was the Ashta Pradhan Mandal?	A council of eight ministers
8. What was chauth?	A tax of 25 per cent
9. Who was Kanhoji Angre?	A Maratha naval leader
10. Who was Tarabai?	A Maratha warrior queen

11. Who recaptured Delhi in 1771?	Mahadji Shinde
12. When was the Battle of Panipat fought?	1761
13. When did Maratha power end?	1818
14. What was Modi?	A cursive form of Devanagari
15. Who was Ekoji?	Shivaji's half-brother
16. Who was Serfoji II?	A notable Thanjavur Maratha ruler
17. What was Dhanwantari Mahal?	A centre for medical treatment
18. What was a cartaz?	A Portuguese naval trade pass
19. Who was Ahilyabai Holkar?	A wise Maratha ruler
20. What were the three parts of the Maratha armed forces?	Infantry, cavalry and navy

Part D: Important long-answer questions for examination

Q1. Describe the rise of the Maratha Empire under Shivaji Maharaj.

Answer: Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj was born in 1630 to Shahji and Jijabai. He grew up in the Pune region and began his military campaigns at the age of sixteen. He captured forts and strengthened their defences. He used guerrilla warfare to defeat larger enemy armies and established a navy to protect the western coast. He fought against the Bijapur Sultanate and the Mughals. After escaping from Agra, he was crowned at Raigad in 1674. He later expanded his kingdom towards southern India. His leadership laid the foundation of the Maratha Empire.

Q2. Explain the main features of Maratha administration.

Answer: Shivaji established a relatively centralised administration. He abolished hereditary government posts, paid officials from the state treasury and transferred officials periodically. He created the Ashta Pradhan Mandal, a council of eight ministers. The Marathas collected taxes such as chauth and sardeshmukhi from certain provinces. Their judicial system used local panchayats and allowed appeals to Maratha chiefs. The army included infantry, cavalry and navy. These arrangements helped the Marathas govern and defend their kingdom.

Q3. Explain the military strengths of the Marathas.

Answer: The Marathas used mountains, forests and coastal areas to their advantage. Their forts controlled important routes and protected soldiers. Guerrilla warfare allowed small groups to attack larger armies through speed and surprise. Shivaji developed a navy to protect the coastline and maritime trade. The Marathas used swords, lances, guns and rockets. Later leaders such as Kanhoji Angre strengthened their naval power.

Q4. Describe the cultural contributions of the Marathas.

Answer: The Marathas promoted Marathi and Sanskrit literature and supported religious institutions and traditional arts. Shivaji's royal seal carried a Sanskrit inscription, and he

commissioned the Rajya-Vyavahara-Kosha to promote Marathi in official communication. Maratha rulers restored temples and encouraged local traditions. In Thanjavur, Maratha rulers supported painting, literature, music, medicine and printing. Serfoji II contributed to Carnatic music and Bharatanatyam and established a centre for medical treatment.

Q5. Explain the reasons for the decline of Maratha power.

Answer: The Marathas suffered a major defeat at the Battle of Panipat in 1761 but later recovered. In the late eighteenth century, they became major rivals of the British. However, growing internal disunity among Maratha chiefs weakened their unity. The British had superior organisational and technological abilities. Three Anglo-Maratha Wars were fought between 1775 and 1818. The Third Anglo-Maratha War ended Maratha power in 1818.

Study tip: First learn the short-answer questions, dates, names and definitions. Then practise the five long answers in your own words. This will help you prepare for objective, short-answer and long-answer questions from the chapter.